MWCF Board: my notes

Wed 11 Nov 2026, 4:00pm, MWCF Support Centre, Mungret. Private. From the Lawler and Máiréad emails and the agenda; the board papers are not for onward sharing.

1. THE AGENDA AND WHERE I COME IN

#	Item	Notes for me
1 to 4	Welcome and apologies; notice and quorum; directors' confirmations; directors' interests	Apologies: Catherine Hand, Linda Fahy. Declare any interest (see section 4).
5	Group photograph (5 min)	
6	Minutes (1 min)	Catherine is happy with them as circulated.
7	**Introduction to John Webb O'Rourke (10 min)**	**My piece**: section 2. About 2 minutes, then questions.
8	Governance update (5 min)	Four drafts awaiting approval. Support in principle; comments by email.
9	Operations and finance overview (10 min)	One gentle question: when does the full finance update arrive?
10	Strategic update (10 min)	Property and Lawler's "day in the life" draft. My property lines: section 3.
11	AOB (5 min)	Lisa Quinn election may come up here or at the start. Nothing else to raise.
12 to 13	Wrap up and actions; next meeting date	Note my actions; ask whether the next meeting is 7 Dec (Catherine asks).

2. MY INTRODUCTION (ABOUT 2 MINUTES, IN MY OWN WORDS)

"Thank you, John. I am delighted to have been invited to join the board, and I look forward to working with you as chairman, with Máiréad and the staff, and with all of you.

I will contribute as best I can. My background is in law, finance, property and governance, and my current focus is AI development and adoption: how organisations can use it practically and safely.

I have been getting to know the Foundation and I am glad to help where I can, including with the question of future premises, which I will report on under the strategic update. Thank you."

- **Optional:** "I chair the Audit and Risk Committee at United Hardware, so governance and risk are familiar ground."
- **Optional:** "I am happy to share what is working with AI in practice, with no pressure on the Foundation."

3. PROPERTY: THREE LINES FOR ITEM 10

- The council has acknowledged my approach through the Mayor's office; Jayne Leahy, Head of Property Services, has my requirements (about 5,000 sq ft plus, a minimum of 8 treatment rooms, ancillary rooms and storage). I asked her for an update before the board.
- The HSE and primary-care route (St Joseph's) is slower: 3 to 6 months at best, and nothing before Christmas.
- **Ask the Board:** authority to continue the property work, minuted, including approaches to the council, the HSE, Gordon Kearney and the McManus Foundation; a small property sub-committee; an options paper at the next meeting.
- **Be consistent:** I told the council "minimum 8 treatment rooms"; the 5 Nov group baseline was about 5,000 sq ft plus, not the 8-room limit. The McManus Foundation's support is verbal and conditional (sale only if a better property is identified first); not yet in writing.

4. DECISIONS AND SIGN-OFFS

- **Lisa Quinn** (marketing, volunteer): elect. Kay, Catherine, Anne Marie Gilmartin, Martina Somers and Linda all agreed by email; I replied "great to hear". Vote yes.
- **Additional cleaning hours** (about 216 euro a month): approve; Catherine supports.
- **Governance drafts** (independent advice, sub-committee policy, skills audit, communications plan): support in principle, comments by email.
- **My sign-offs:** Constitution and Mission Statement acknowledgement (overdue), Information Pack acceptance, declaration of interests, skills audit (due 27 Nov, back to John Lawler).
- **Interests to consider declaring:** my other property interests (Croom, Julianstown, Tairseach property intelligence), in case a candidate site touches my contacts.

5. THE EMAILS IN SHORT

- **Máiréad, 6 Nov:** board pack (agenda, October minutes, November operational overview).
- **John Lawler, 4 Nov:** governance documents; comments by email; skills audit needs my direct reply; use chairperson@mwcf.ie from now on.
- **John Lawler, 9 Nov:** "Mungret Day in the Life" draft; asks for my thoughts. No reply from me yet: "thank you, comments to follow" is enough.
- **John Lawler, 10 Nov:** proposes electing Lisa Quinn at the meeting.
- **Catherine Hand, 6 Nov:** apologies; supports cleaning hours; mentions the Strand Hotel event on 7 Dec (my note says Wed 9 Dec: **check**); asks whether the next board is 7 Dec; wants to explore recruiting volunteers.

6. THE ROOM

- **Present (from emails):** John Lawler (chair), Máiréad O'Donnell (General Manager), Kay Chawke, Anne Marie Gilmartin (Clinical Nurse Manager, Cancer Services, UHL), Martina Somers (treasurer). StJohn Dundon (Dundon Callanan, solicitors) and Liam Toland not confirmed. Lisa Quinn if elected.
- **Absent:** Catherine Hand, Linda Fahy (HSE).
- **The Board is divided on premises** (October minutes, not attributed): some say the current site is fine, several prefer San Martino, others dislike shared primary-care space. Listen for who says what.
- **Do not repeat** the private remarks about the Board made on the 5 Nov call. No challenges today; observe and build confidence.

7. BEFORE I LEAVE

- Reply to John Lawler: "thank you for the Day in the Life draft, comments to follow".
- Check: Strand Hotel date (7 or 9 Dec); next meeting date; tenancy end date at Mungret (October minutes: five months left at 21 Oct).
- Draft follow-ups: Joe (St Joseph's), Joe Hoare (HSE), Gordon Kearney (drafts in Gmail); a note to Máiréad on the finance update.